

tion, which was published in a magazine, regarding the exponential increase in the number of transistors that could be included in a single chip. Though he had originally observed that transistor count doubled every year, this was later modified to every two years. The statement was dubbed Moore's law in 1970.

October: The Dot Matrix Printer

Seiko Epson, the official time-keeper of the Tokyo Olympics, was asked to integrate a small printer with the timer so that human intervention could be reduced in the recording process. This led to the invention of the dot matrix printer. The printer was not mass-produced for another four years.

Computers Get, Well, Faster!

The CDC 6600 supercomputer, designed by Seymour Cray, was launched by Control Data Corporation. Capable of performing up to 3 million instructions per second, it was three times faster than its closest competitor, the IBM Stretch. The 6600 retained the distinction of being the fastest computer in the world until surpassed by its successor, the CDC 7600, in 1968. Internally, the 6600 had 10 small computers, known as pre-processors, funnelling data to a large central processing unit.

Online Transaction Processing

American Airlines' SABRE system was launched. SABRE (Semi-Automated Business Research Environment), built by IBM, used teletype machines connected through dialup connections to mainframe computers to create an automatic reservation system. While the earlier manual method could take about 90 minutes to issue a ticket, through SABRE this duration was reduced to three seconds! This was a first implementation of an online transaction processing system. The network included 2,000 teletype terminals in various cities, connected to a pair of IBM 7090 computers.

Handwriting Recognition

The RAND tablet was developed by M R Davis and T D Ellis at Rand Corporation. Also called the Grafacon (for Graphic Converter), it is